The Means of Accomplishment of Two-Armed Hevajra

Hevajradvibhujasādhana · Toh 1271 · Derge Tengyur

ཀྱེ་རྡོ་རྗེ་ཕྱག་གཉིས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས

The Means of Accomplishment of Two-Armed Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as the Hevajra Dvibhuja Sādhana and in Tibetan as Kyé Dorjé Chak Nyipé Druptap, is a short tantric meditation manual, or sādhana, for the practice of Hevajra in his two-armed form, embraced by his consort Nairātmyā. Composed by the Indian master Tāraśrī and translated into Tibetan by the Nepalese paṇḍita Sumatikīrti together with Marpa Chöwang, it guides the yogin from rising at dawn through offerings, confession, refuge, the four immeasurables and meditation on emptiness, into the visualization of oneself as the deity, followed by the inviting of wisdom beings, empowerment, the blessing of inner offering substances, and the recitation of the twelve-syllable mantra. It is Toh 1271 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of tantra commentaries, among the many practice texts associated with the Hevajra Tantra.

In the language of India: he vajra dvibhuja sādhanaṃ. In the language of Tibet: The Means of Accomplishment of Two-Armed Hevajra.

Homage to the venerable one of great compassion.

Bowing to the Blood-Drinker Trailokyākṣepa
And to the glorious protector, the guru,
I shall set forth the rite for accomplishing him
As it was taught by the venerable Śānti.

The hero, with one face and two arms,
Is embraced about the neck by Nairātmyā;
He is adorned with the wheel and the other ornaments,
Has three eyes, and his two feet rest upon a lotus.

The yogin who wishes to gain mastery in meditation on this tantra rises from his bed early in the morning and visualizes a syllable hūṃ resting on a sun in his own heart. With its rays he makes glorious Heruka appear, and worships him well with the five offerings of flowers and so forth. In his presence he confesses his wrongdoing, rejoices in merit, and goes for refuge. He generates the mind set on great awakening, and then cultivates loving-kindness, which brings to all sentient beings the happiness of divine substances; compassion, in the aspect of removing all suffering; joy, in the aspect of certainty that those happinesses will continue without interruption; and equanimity, whose characteristic is not attending to afflictions, secondary afflictions, the grasped and the grasper, and so forth.

Then he meditates on emptiness: the nature untainted by the stains of phenomena, persons and the like, which enters into the way in which all phenomena are unarisen. He consecrates this with oṃ śūnyatājñāna vajra svadhāva ātmako 'haṃ.

Then, being roused, he visualizes in the region of the sky a syllable hūṃ resting on a sun disc. From its transformation he visualizes a syllable hūṃ resting at the hub of a vajra. With forms of glorious Heruka issuing from its rays he accomplishes the benefit of all beings without exception, and then draws them back into that very syllable.

From its transformation arises glorious Heruka, seated on a sun disc upon a corpse that lies on the petals of a variegated lotus. He has two arms and three eyes. In his right hand he holds a vajra, and in his left a skull cup marked with a vajra. He is dancing and wears a lower garment of tiger skin. On his head is a wheel made of human heads, embodying Akṣobhya; on his ears are ring-shaped earrings, embodying Amitābha; at his throat a necklace, embodying Ratnasambhava; on his arms bracelets, embodying Vairocana; and at his waist a girdle, embodying Amoghasiddhi. He wears a sacred cord of hair, armlets and anklets, and his reddish-yellow hair stands upward. He is embraced by Nairātmyā, who has one face and two arms and holds a curved knife and a skull cup. He meditates on himself as having become such a one.

Then he should conceive of Nairātmyā in his ears, Vajrā in his eyes, Secret Gaurī in his nose, Vāriyoginī in his tongue, Vajraḍākinī in his body faculty, and Nairātmyā in his mind.

Then, at the head, upon a lotus of thirty-two petals, is a syllable haṃ facing downward. At the throat, upon one of sixteen petals, is a syllable oṃ facing upward. At the heart, upon one of eight petals, is a syllable hūṃ facing downward. At the navel, upon one of sixty-four petals, he should imagine a syllable aṃ facing upward.

Then he invites the wisdom being, which is like the commitment being, and with this mantra, jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ, summons it, causes it to enter, binds it, and brings it under control, making the two of one taste, like milk and water.

Immediately after that, with the rays from the syllable hūṃ at the hub of a vajra on the sun in his own heart, he invites Heruka, the nature of all the Tathāgatas, makes offerings, and supplicates: "May all the Tathāgatas grant me empowerment." Then they empower him with jewel vases filled with the five nectars, and he imagines Akṣobhya as his crown ornament. Then all the yoginīs of the assembly make offerings with substances such as their own awakening mind.

Then he praises with this verse:

Baring your fangs, you are greatly terrifying,
Adorned with a garland of flowers of entrails,
You who partake of the great meats:
Glorious Heruka, I pay homage to you.

Then, in the sky, from the transformation of hūṃ there is a vajra. Beneath it, from the transformation of the syllable āḥ, there is a lotus vessel. Within it are the commitment substances go ku da ha na, marked with the syllable oṃ, and ma ra mu śu bi and the rest. From the union of vajra and lotus fire blazes; the substances are heated, and when they have cooked they are made into liquid. It is made into a sun of wisdom that holds the forms of all the Tathāgatas, and with the rays of that wisdom seed the wisdom nectar of all the Tathāgatas is drawn in and combined with the substances. He consecrates it with the three syllables oṃ āḥ hūṃ, makes his tongue into the nature of a vajra arisen from a white syllable hūṃ, and with it satisfies himself.

Then he vividly visualizes with his mind the garland of the twelve-syllable mantra, oṃ trelokyākśepa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā, set circling well around the syllable hūṃ at the hub of a vajra on the sun of light in his heart, blazing like a garland of lamps; and he recites it without interruption, in the order stated.

For the midday and afternoon sessions, he makes himself in an instant into the form of glorious Heruka, and then performs the purification of the eyes and so forth, the meditation on the four of the retinue, offering, praise, the tasting of nectar, and so on.

By whatever merit has been gained
Through composing this supreme means of accomplishment
Of the hero Trailokyākṣepa,
May all beings become Vajradhara.

The Means of Accomplishment of Two-Armed Hevajra is complete. It was composed by the venerable great scholar Tāraśrī, and translated by the Nepalese paṇḍita Sumatikīrti and the Tibetan translator Marpa Chöwang.

Translator's Notes

- In the opening verse, "zhi ba yi zhal snga nas" is taken as an honorific reference to a teacher named Śānti (perhaps Ratnākaraśānti, Śāntipa); it could instead qualify the rite as "peaceful", which is less likely given the honorific "zhal snga nas". "Secret Gaurī" translates gsang ba'i dkar mo literally; no firmer Sanskrit form is certain. At the navel the Tibetan gives only "facing" without a direction; "upward" is supplied from the alternating pattern of the other syllables. The syllables go ku da ha na and ma ra mu śu bi are the usual code initials for the five meats and five nectars of the samaya substances.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.